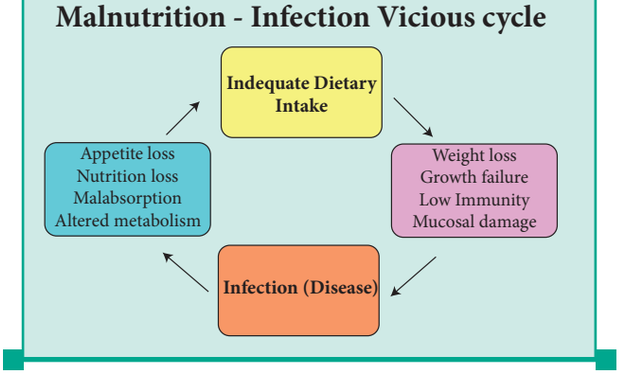
The global Nutrition report 2017 states that 38 percent of Indian children are stunted and 21 percent are severely wasted highlighting that proper nutrition is the solution to end poverty and fight disease conditions in our country

Malnutrition is the condition that develops when the body does not get the right amount of the vitamins, minerals, and other nutrients it needs to maintain healthy tissues and organ function.



▲ Fig. 7 Vicious Cycle of Malnutrition

- **Protein Energy Malnutrition**

It is a group of body depletion disorders which includes kwashiorkor, marasmus and the intermediate stages.

i. **Marasmus:** Marasmus is derived from the Greek Word "Marasmos" which means wasting. Marasmus involves inadequate intake of calories and protein. It represents simple starvation. The body adapts to the stress of deficit in protein and calories.



▲ Fig. 8 Signs and symptoms of Malnutrition

ii. **Kwashiorkor:** Kwashiorkor is a form of severe protein–energy malnutrition with sufficient calorie

Table 2. Difference between Marasmus and Kwashiorkar on signs & symptoms

Marasmus	Kwashiorkar
Severe growth retardation	Low body weight
Loss of subcutaneous fat	Pitting edema on feet and legs
Severe muscle wasting	Puffiness (edema) on face (moon face)
Wrinkled Skin	Apathy and irritability
Failure to thrive,	Scaly pigmentation of skin
Dehydration	Loss of hair
Temperature is subnormal	Hair discoloration
Frequent watery diarrohea and acid stools	Anorexia
Oedema and fatty infiltration are absent	Diarrohea due to defective digestion
Irritability, fretfulness and apathy	Hyper pigmentation

Source: www.yourarticlelibrary.com/flood/constituents/constituents-of-food-and-its-functions/64425

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